



The swivel screen of the Acer TravelMate 100 enables it to be used as a notepad as well as a tablet PC. And it also has touchscreen support thrown in

A single pushbutton on the screen lets you change the orientation of the display from portrait to landscape—ideal for presentations

The 10.4-inch display is about the size of an A4 page and features a resolution of 1024x768 with 24-bit colour support driven by a SMI Lynx 3DM+ graphics chipset

The Fujitsu Siemens LT P-600 sports a 600 MHz P-III processor with a touchscreen—all in an 8-inch package

In spite of its size, this portable machine packs in a 700 MHz PIII-M processor with SpeedStep technology helping you maximise battery power while on the road

The Viewsonic ViewPad 1100 features 802.11b wireless networking, handwriting recognition and an 866 MHz P-III processor

of your scribbling and copy them into conventional applications such as Word and even your messenger client!

The rocket in your pocket

Maybe you are a sales executive, en route to a client's office. You receive a phone call saying that some specifications of the product have undergone last minute changes. If you have one of these new handhelds, all you need to do is log into the company network using the wireless Internet access, pull down the latest specifications and integrate them into your

PowerPoint presentation—all on the trip to the clients office!

Sounds too good to be true? Going one step smaller, the next regiment of road warriors are represented by PDAs. These little handheld devices have jumped manifold in everything, from processing power, to applications and

connectivity. They fit all the information you need within the reach of a stylus, all your documents inside your pocket. The PDAs run on a new breed of processors, built specifically to ensure that these devices don't skimp on the applications (see box 'The brains behind the beauty').

Running at 400 MHz, the new devices have transfective screens that make as clearly readable in total darkness as bright sunlight. With a resolution of 240x320, 16-bit colour and 32 MB of memory, these devices can handle motion (30 fps) video playback and audio. Such processing power, combined with scaled down and optimised versions of operating systems, makes the response time of these devices very fluid and speedy. Enhanced power conservation methods ensure better battery management and battery life (see box, 'Power that lasts').

Devices that embody the amalgam of pocket computers include the O2 XDA, the Hewlett-Packard iPAQ 3950, the Fujitsu Siemens Pocket LOOX and Sony Clie PEG-NR70V.

The O2 XDA is quite a thing for those who need to be connected at all times—it's like a conventional Pocket PC inside it lurk GPRS support, POP3 e-mail, Instant Messengers and even a phone! The bright full-colour 240x320 resolution shows off rich multimedia content and its connectivity will never keep you away from your vital information for long.

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